



Funnel-web spiders in Australia

The rain in Australia provided relief from the fires, but it also brought a surge of deadly funnel web spiders. <https://digit.in/feb20-41>



10 facts about spiders

Learn about some of the coolest, lesser-known facts about these fascinating eight-legged creatures. <https://digit.in/feb20-42>

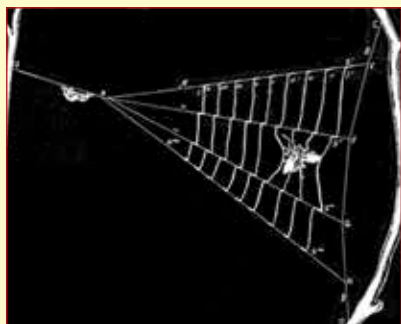


While we may be familiar with only one kind of spider web, different spiders actually craft a variety of webs, using a range of underlying geometries, that are as diverse as the nests of birds.

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↑ Orb web spiders belong to a family known as Araneidae, and are the most common types of spiders. They make circular wheel shaped spider webs with spokes, and are the most familiar shape of spider webs.



← The triangle web weavers have an anchor line that they can tighten as the prey lands on the web, causing the prey to get trapped after contact with additional strands in the web.



← Sheet web spiders or Stiphidiidae are long legged spiders that can create enormous webs spanning across jungle trails. They can also make dome shaped webs.



← Funnel web spiders build tube shaped or funnel shaped "traps" with dense webbing, in rocks and crevices. The webs are not sticky, but the prey can nonetheless get entangled.



← The cobweb spiders are also known as tangle webbed spiders and create irregular webs along the corners of dwellings. These spiders build webs to trap a variety of prey.



← The mesh web weavers belong to the family of Dictynidae, and build irregular and horribly tangled webs spanning across multiple branches of a single plant.



← While most spiders are solitary, social spiders form long lasting aggregations known as colonies, that build colossal webs as a communal effort.